to ACME's list of trusted auditors. To do this, Tim reviewed the NISA governance framework, which details the requirements for becoming an accredited security auditing firm and the steps organizations must follow to maintain that status. The framework also describes how NISA assesses and certifies individual auditors, including the issuance of the CISA-R credential that Angela holds. These procedures helped Tim understand both the organizational accreditation for AuditsRUs and the asserted qualifications of the auditors it employs.

As part of the review, Tim examined the accreditation credential issued to AuditsRUs by NISA. The credential verified that AuditsRUs met NISA's standards and was authorized to issue employment and role credentials for security auditors working under its supervision. Tim verified the credential's signature, checked its validity period, and confirmed that it had not been revoked. He also confirmed that the credential identified AuditsRUs as the accredited organization by comparing the legal name, organizational identifier, and public key in the credential with the information NISA publishes in its governance framework and with the materials AuditsRUs had provided during his review.

Satisfied that AuditsRUs was a legitimate NISA-accredited auditor, Tim added AuditsRUs to ACME's internal registry of issuers. Importantly, ACME did not just trust AuditsRUs for audit work; it also trusted AuditsRUs to issue any credentials that NISA's governance framework allowed them to, such as verifying employment, role assignments, and audit qualifications of their staff. By recording this in ACME's governance system, the trust relationship was formalized and made available in ACME's trust store (described in the next section).

This onboarding step meant that when Angela later presented her employment credential from AuditsRUs and her CISA-R certification credential from NISA, ACME already knew how to evaluate them. The cryptography provided confidence that the credentials were genuine and linked to Angela's wallet, while ACME's trust in NISA and AuditsRUs, established earlier by Tim, provided assurance that the claims were authoritative.